

THE INNER CIRCLE TRADER

The ICT Concept Taxonomy

A year-indexed map of concepts taught on the official channel

youtube.com/@innercircletrader

2013–2015	Origins & Market Maker language
2016–2017	Private Mentorship Core Content
2018–2021	Charter models, IFVG, IPDA
2022	Public YouTube Mentorship & 2022 Model
2023	Silver Bullet refinement & One Setup
2024	Mentorship, CISD, CRT era
2025	Venom, Suspension, Lecture Series
2026	SMC lectures, macros, session models

Purpose and scope

This document is a **year-indexed taxonomy** of trading concepts taught by Michael J. Huddleston — The Inner Circle Trader (ICT) — on the official YouTube channel youtube.com/@innercircletrader. It is a study map, not a substitute for the lectures. ICT's language evolved over more than a decade: the same idea is often restated with a tighter definition, a new name, or a narrower time window. Where a concept is associated with a year, that year is the period it was *taught or popularised in the public record on the channel*, not a claim that the price behaviour itself was invented then.

Primary source: official playlists on @InnerCircleTrader. Secondary structure cross-checked against the 2016–17 Core Content month titles, the 2022 Mentorship (41 episodes), the 2023–2026 named playlists (2023 Mentorship, 2024 Mentorship, 2025 Lecture Series / Shotgun Saturday, 2026 Smart Money Concept Lectures), and Charter Content models.

How this taxonomy is organised

Two axes. First, a **conceptual family** — what kind of thing the idea is (structure, liquidity, PD array, time, model). Second, a **year index** — when that family was built out on the channel. Study by year if you want the historical curriculum. Study by family if you want a working toolbox.

A note on attribution and community terms

Some labels now common in Smart Money Concepts (SMC) communities — notably CHoCH as a rigid two-candle rule, some CRT formulations, and various indicator names — were standardised by students more tightly than ICT himself used them. This taxonomy flags community-amplified terms. ICT's own emphasis, especially from 2022 onward, is time + liquidity + displacement + first presented imbalance, not a growing zoo of named patterns.

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1. Conceptual families

Every named ICT idea sits in one of eight families. Later years mostly add refinements and time-boxed models, not new physics.

Family	What it answers	Canonical members
Market structure	Which way is the algorithm currently delivering?	Swing points · HH/HL vs LH/LL · BOS · MSS · CISD · dealing range · IRL vs ERL
Liquidity	Where are the stops, and which pool is the draw?	BSL / SSL · EQH / EQL · PDH/PDL/PWH/PWL · inducement · stop hunt / Turtle Soup · IRL ↔ ERL · DOL
Imbalance / PD arrays	Where does price reprice after displacement?	FVG · IFVG · BPR · CE · Volume Imbalance · NDOG / NWOG · First Presented FVG
Order-flow blocks	Where did the originating order likely sit?	Order Block · Breaker · Mitigation Block · Rejection / wick block · Propulsion · Hidden OB · Suspension Block
Time & sessions	When is delivery expected?	Killzones · Macros · Asian Range · Judas Swing · Power of 3 / AMD · Silver Bullet windows · Opening Range · Quarterly Theory / IPDA lookbacks
Confluence tools	What confirms the narrative?	SMT Divergence · OTE (0.62 / 0.705 / 0.79) · Premium vs Discount · Mean Threshold
Named models	A complete sequence you can execute.	MMXM (buy/sell) · 2022 Model · Silver Bullet · Unicorn · One Shot One Kill · CRT sequence · Venom · Charter PAM 1–13
Risk & process	How the student survives the curriculum.	Fixed fractional risk · structural stops · partials · journaling · no live trading during Phase 1 study

Hierarchy ICT repeatedly returns to: **HTF bias** → **draw on liquidity** → **killzone / macro time** → **liquidity raid** → **displacement / MSS or CISD** → **PD array (usually first presented FVG or OB) in premium or discount** → **target the opposing liquidity**. Named models are packaged versions of that chain.

2. Origins — 2013 to 2015

Before the 2016 paid mentorship, the channel and related early lectures already used institutional language: market makers condition price, retail is the liquidity, and time of day matters. Much of this later reappears as AMD / Power of 3, SMT, and Market Maker Models.

Concept / series	Role in the later taxonomy
Introduction to Forex & its pitfalls (~2013)	Retail vs interbank framing; why most retail tools fail.
Market Maker Series (2014, later 2021 remake)	How a dealing desk engineers a range: accumulate, run stops, deliver. Ancestor of MMXM and AMD.
Essentials of market structure / market mapping	Swing anatomy; not yet the later MSS/CISD vocabulary.
SMT Concept (documented ~2015)	Smart Money Technique / intermarket divergence — correlated assets fail to confirm a high or low.
Precision Trading Concepts (3 volumes)	Price delivery as precision, not pattern-book retail TA.
Wolfe Waves, COT, intermarket notes	Early confluence tools; COT later sits inside Trading Plan Development.
Order block explanations (rare early clips, e.g. 2016 live)	Institutional origin candle — later formalised as the PD-array OB.

Official / reconstructed homes on the channel: Lost & Found historical lessons, Market Maker Primer (ForeXmas retitle), Precision Trading Concepts playlist, SMT standalone lectures.

3. 2016–2017 Private Mentorship Core Content

The dictionary year. Roughly twelve months of lectures (often cited as ~115 lessons) later uploaded by ICT himself as month-by-month playlists. This is where the vocabulary that later SMC absorbed was defined: premium/discount, liquidity runs, order blocks, breakers, mitigation, rejection blocks, time and price, killzones in ancestral form, and separate swing / short-term / day-trade / scalp models.

Month map (as originally distributed)

Month	Era title	Concepts planted
1 · Sep 2016	Elements of a trade setup	Expansion / retracement / reversal / consolidation · market-maker conditioning · equilibrium vs premium vs discount · fair valuation · liquidity runs (HRL / LRL) · impulse swings and market protraction
2 · Oct 2016	Growing accounts & traps	Position sizing · compounding · drawdown math · framing low-risk setups · market-maker false flags and false breakouts · psychology of loss
3 · Nov 2016	Time & price I + order flow	Timeframe selection · institutional order flow · institutional sponsorship · anticipatory skill · institutional market structure · session highs/lows as time maps
4–5 · Dec 16 / Jan 17	PD array matrix	Order Blocks · Mitigation Blocks · Breaker Blocks · Rejection Blocks · reinforcing liquidity and price delivery · interest-rate / FX context · double top/bottom as liquidity, not patterns · SMT-style “divergence phantoms”
6	Swing trading model	Classic swing approach · weekly/daily dealing ranges · HTF PD arrays
7	Short-term trading model	Multi-day delivery · intermediate premium/discount
8	Day-trading model	Intraday profiles · high-probability day-trade setups · session templates
9	Amplified day-trading & scalping	Compression of the same logic into lower timeframes
10	Other markets	Commodity, bond, index futures, and stock applications of the same arrays
11	ICT Megatrades	Low-frequency, HTF-displacement swing campaigns
12	Top-down analysis	Monthly → weekly → daily → session workflow, end-to-end

On the official channel these appear as playlists titled “2016 ICT Private Mentorship Core Content Month 01” through Month 12 (Month 12 is labelled 2017). Watch uncut first; “core cuts” fan edits are useful on a second pass.

PD Array hierarchy as taught in this era

The dealing range is split at equilibrium (50%). Buys are sought in discount; sells in premium. Inside that range ICT ranks reaction levels. A working order used by students (and later restated) is roughly:

1. Liquidity pool (the draw)
2. Fair Value Gap / imbalance
3. Order Block
4. Breaker
5. Mitigation Block
6. Rejection / wick block
7. OTE retracement inside the impulse.

Later years add IFVG, BPR, First Presented FVG, Hidden OB, Propulsion, Suspension, and volume imbalance — they are children of this matrix, not a replacement for it.

4. 2017–2021 — public series, Charter, IPDA

After Core Content, ICT published free series that drilled pattern recognition and packaged complete models. Charter Content is the private-model catalogue (Price Action Models 1–13). IPDA and Inverse FVG become explicit.

Year / series	What was added to the taxonomy
2017 · OTE Pattern Recognition (Vols. 1–20 + drills)	Optimal Trade Entry formalised on the ICT Fibonacci set (62%–79%, with 70.5% as the sweet spot). OTE is a location inside a displacement leg, not a standalone strategy.
Scout Sniper Basic Field Guide (8 modules)	Killzone stalking, institutional order blocks, ADR targeting, multi-target management — field manual for the Core Content ideas.
Mastering High Probability Scalping	LTF application of the same PD arrays; development exercises.
Trading Plan Development series	Process: tools, COT, SMT inside a written plan, term-structure of trades (swing / short / intra).

Year / series	What was added to the taxonomy
~2018–2019 · block taxonomy + IFVG + IPDA	Inverse Fair Value Gap (an FVG that flips role after being traded through). IPDA — Interbank Price Delivery Algorithm — and 20 / 40 / 60-day lookbacks as data ranges the algorithm is said to reference. Quarterly / fractal time ideas begin here and later surface as Quarterly Theory discussions.
2020 · Micro-Market Structure & Time & Price	LTF structure inside the HTF narrative; session-time precision.
2021 · Market Maker Series (5 volumes, remake)	MMXM restated for a new audience: buy model and sell model as engineered sequences.
Charter Content (PAM 1–13, uploaded as a playlist)	Complete boxed models: scalping, short-term, swing, position, volatility expansion, Universal Trading Model, 6%/month targeting, One Shot One Kill, and a Charter lecture on the later 2022 YouTube model. Charter is “pick a model and run it,” not new physics.
If I Could Go Back & Tell Myself... (4 parts)	Curriculum advice from ICT to a younger student — useful orientation, not new arrays.
W.E.N.T. / “What Every New Trader wants to know”	Survey of the 20-year toolkit; good index of what he considered core before 2022.

5. 2022 — Public Mentorship and the 2022 Model

*The simplification year. In January 2022 ICT announced a free public mentorship on YouTube. The official playlist **2022 ICT Mentorship** contains 41 core episodes (plus companion “Ends Series / How to Make Ends Meet”). Taught primarily on index futures (ES / NQ). This is the sequence most modern SMC creators compress.*

The 2022 delivery chain

Daily / session draw on liquidity → **liquidity raid** (Judas / stop run of Asia or prior day) → **displacement** (impulsive delivery leaving imbalance) → **Market Structure Shift (MSS)** → **Fair Value Gap entry** in the correct premium or discount side → target the opposing pool (IRL then ERL).

2022 concept	Function
2022 Model (the self-contained model)	The full-day packaged version of the chain above, usually framed around NY delivery on indices.
Silver Bullet (introduced / popularised here; refined 2023+)	Time-boxed FVG entry inside a one-hour killzone window. Canonical NY window 10:00–11:00 ET; London and PM analogues exist.
Displacement as a filter	Not every gap is tradeable. The impulse must be algorithmic — large bodies, leftover FVG, shift in delivery.
MSS on the trading timeframe	Confirmation that the raid was a reversal, not a run-on. Later distinguished from CISD.
First-presented imbalance (logic already present; named more tightly later)	The first FVG created by the displacement is the preferred entry array.
Intraday AMD / Judas at the cash open	9:30 ET (or London open) often prints the manipulation leg of Power of 3.
Ends Series	Process: how a student actually pays bills with one model — psychology and expectancy, not new arrays.

Official playlist: “2022 ICT Mentorship” (list=PLVgHx4Z63paYiFGQ56PjTF1PGePL3r69s).

6. 2023 — Silver Bullet and one setup

*Official playlist: **2023 ICT Mentorship plus 2023 Forex Reviews**. The year is less about new arrays and more about reducing the 2022 chain to a repeatable timed model and showing it live.*

2023 emphasis	Notes
Silver Bullet as “the” timed model	Lecture explicitly titled as a time-based trading model; follow-up examples of an evolving SB.
One Trading Setup For Life	Long-form argument that a single well-understood sequence beats a catalogue of patterns.

2023 emphasis	Notes
Market Maker Models revisited	MMXM restated against 2022/23 tape — accumulation, manipulation (Judas), distribution.
High-frequency / algorithmic entry notes	Tighter discussion of when the algorithm is “on” inside the session.
Live reviews	2023 Forex Reviews playlist — application, not definition.

7. 2024 Mentorship — CISD, opening range, CRT era

*Official playlist: **ICT 2024 Mentorship**. Lectures resume in force from August 2024 (multi-hour weekend sessions). The conceptual additions are mostly finer state-of-delivery language and range-based framing of the same 2022 chain.*

2024 concept	Taxonomy note
Change in State of Delivery (CISD)	Order-flow shift: last opposing candle’s open (or defined delivery level) is reclaimed by a close. ICT treats CISD as the cause and MSS as the visible structure effect. Used heavily on LTF execution.
Opening Range Theory / first presented FVG logic	Define a session opening range (often 9:30–10:00 ET on indices). Displacement that sweeps the range, then the first FVG of that displacement, is the entry. A dedicated channel lecture exists: “ICT Opening Range Theory — 1st Presented FVG Logic.”
Candle Range Theory (CRT)	Treat a reference candle (or opening range treated as a candle) as a three-phase range: raid one side, deliver through the other. Widely systematised in 2024–25 student literature; ICT uses the underlying idea (AMD on a single candle / range) more than a rigid CRT brand. Marked here as era-associated.
Seek & Destroy	Days where the algorithm raids both sides and does not deliver a clean expansion — stand aside. Named in 2024 reviews.
NDOG / NWOOG as standing arrays	New Day / New Week Opening Gaps treated as multi-day reference imbalances, not just noise.
Tape-reading emphasis	Watch delivery candle-by-candle inside the killzone rather than pre-drawing every array.
Unicorn / SMT packaged entries	FVG + OB overlap (Unicorn) confirmed by SMT on a correlated market — confluence model, not a new array type.

8. 2025 — Venom, Suspension, Lecture Series

*Official playlists: **2025 Lecture Series** and **2025 Shotgun Saturday**, plus continuing trade-execution clips. 2025 is a model-packaging year: named sequences that lock the 2022/24 logic to the NY open.*

2025 concept	Taxonomy note
Venom Model (April 2025)	NY-open execution model. Typical skeleton: build 9:30–10:00 ET opening range → raid / displacement relative to that range → change in delivery → first presented FVG (or CISD + FVG) entry. Student write-ups also fuse MMXM + CRT + SMT; treat those fusions as commentary unless the lecture itself states them.
First Presented FVG (tightened rule)	The first gap printed by the session’s displacement is graded above later gaps.
Suspension Block	PD array introduced in 2025 lectures — a pause / suspended delivery reference inside the dealing range (see the source lecture; community definitions vary).
Enigma FVG / Reaper IFVG	Named FVG / IFVG variants in the 2024–25 advanced cluster. Use the lecture definition; do not mix vendor indicator rules with ICT’s tape.
RDRB (remaining imbalance after partial fill)	After an FVG is partially rebalanced, the leftover slice stays an active array.
Propulsion Block	Timing / ignition block — the order-flow pocket that launches the expansion leg.
Silver Bullet 2025 refinement	Same hour windows, stricter displacement and first-FVG filters.
Pre-market gradients / macro framework	7:00–9:30 ET delivery as setup for the cash-open algorithm, not a separate strategy.

9. 2026 — SMC lectures and session algorithms

Official playlist: 2026 ICT Smart Money Concept Lecture, plus dated session reviews (Asian Session, New York Lunch Algorithmic Theory, pre-market framework, MOC / market-on-close macro, live MNQ / US100 executions). As of this compilation (September 2026) the year is application-heavy: same families, tighter clock.

2026 emphasis	Notes
Session algorithms as separate clocks	Asia, London, NY AM, NY lunch, NY PM, MOC treated as distinct delivery windows with their own opening ranges and first presented imbalances.
NY Lunch algorithmic theory	Dedicated 2026 lecture — midday is not dead time; it has its own raid/deliver profile.
Pre-market → 9:30 open framework	7:00 ET displacement feeding the cash-open Judas / opening-range story.
CISD in live execution titles	2026 clips explicitly tag “Smart Money Concepts Live Trade PreSession CISD.”
Zircon / further named models	Mentioned in student curricula as demo-stage 2026 packaging. Verify on the channel before treating as canonical — ICT names models in lectures, not in third-party lists.
Price Action Chronicles	Ongoing official playlist of applied tape, sitting beside the yearly lecture series.

10. Official playlists by year

Use the Playlists tab on youtube.com/@innercircletrader as the index of record. Titles below are as they appear on the channel. Playlist IDs included where stable.

Year	Official playlist (channel)
2016–17	2016 ICT Private Mentorship Core Content Month 01–12 (separate playlists per month). Month 12 labelled 2017.
Evergreen / pre-2022	ICT Charter Content · Precision Trading Concepts · Market Maker Primer · Market Maker Series (2021) · Scout Sniper · High Probability Scalping · Trading Plan Development · OTE Pattern Recognition · Micro-Market Structure & Time & Price · If I Could Go Back... · W.E.N.T. · Price Action Chronicles
2022	2022 ICT Mentorship — list=PLVgHx4Z63paYiFGQ56PjTF1PGePL3r69s (41 episodes)
2023	2023 ICT Mentorship — list=PLVgHx4Z63pabpjlduWBaEsn8VMtALhjGV · 2023 Forex Reviews
2024	ICT 2024 Mentorship — list=PLVgHx4Z63paaM41aubnH0mqfNjSAoBCV
2025	2025 Lecture Series — list=PLVgHx4Z63paYf6xk2a8KKuf2CYJ8SX0Wy · 2025 Shotgun Saturday — list=PLVgHx4Z63paaz_g4Uz_JLCfM3NACgZ6F9
2026	2026 ICT Smart Money Concept Lecture — list=PLVgHx4Z63paaja3GW0dYSr6y_V2Sttx4-
Applied tape (multi-year)	ICT Trade Executions · ICT Price Action Chronicles

Channel handle to verify before any re-upload: @InnerCircleTrader (also linked as youtube.com/@innercircletrader). Re-uploads are common; the official playlists tab is the safest index.

11. Suggested study order

ICT's own public advice since 2022 has been consistent: do not try to drink the entire 2016 firehose first if you only need a working model. A practical order that still respects the year index:

- **Phase A — Vocabulary (2–4 weeks, charts only).** Liquidity (BSL/SSL, EQH/EQL), premium vs discount, dealing range, FVG anatomy, order block anatomy, displacement, killzones. Sources: 2016 Month 1 + Month 4 OB lectures, plus any short 2022 episode that defines FVG and liquidity.
- **Phase B — One model (2022 Mentorship, episodes in order).** Learn the raid → displacement → MSS → FVG chain on ES/NQ or a major FX pair. Paper only. Add Silver Bullet as the timed subset.
- **Phase C — Time precision.** 2023 Silver Bullet lectures, then 2024 Opening Range / CISD / first presented FVG. Still one setup.

- **Phase D — Depth, not more entries.** 2016 Months 2 (risk), 3 (time & price), 6–9 (model variants), Charter PAM that matches your horizon, SMT, MMXM.
- **Phase E — Current tape.** 2025 Lecture Series / Venom only after Phase B is mechanical. 2026 session lectures as live application of the same chain.
- **Standing rule from the 2016 curriculum:** no live capital while you are still in anatomy class. Bar-replay first.

What not to do: collect every 2025 named block before you can mark yesterday's buy-side and sell-side liquidity without thinking. The taxonomy is large because the channel is large — the trade is small.

12. Compact glossary

Term	Short definition
AMD / Power of 3	Accumulation → Manipulation → Distribution. The daily (or candle) narrative.
BSL / SSL	Buy-side liquidity above highs; sell-side liquidity below lows.
BOS	Break of Structure — continuation break of the active swing sequence.
BPR	Balanced Price Range — overlap of two opposing FVGs.
Breaker	An order block that failed and then flipped role after being traded through.
CE	Consequent Encroachment — 50% of an FVG.
CISD	Change in State of Delivery — close back through the defined delivery level.
Dealing range	The swing high-to-low (or session range) inside which PD arrays are graded.
Displacement	Impulsive, one-sided delivery that leaves imbalance and shows intent.
DOL	Draw on Liquidity — the pool price is expected to seek next.
EQH / EQL	Equal highs / equal lows — obvious stop clusters.
ERL / IRL	External vs internal range liquidity.
FVG	Fair Value Gap — three-candle inefficiency (wick of 1 and 3 fail to overlap).
IFVG	Inverse FVG — a gap that changes role after price trades through it.
IPDA	Interbank Price Delivery Algorithm — ICT's name for scheduled institutional delivery.
Judas Swing	The manipulation leg that runs stops the wrong way before true delivery.
Killzone	Session window when ICT expects algorithmic delivery (Asia, London, NY AM/PM, LC).
MSS	Market Structure Shift — structure confirmation after a raid.
NDOG / NWOOG	New Day / New Week Opening Gap.
OB	Order Block — last opposing candle before a displacing impulse.
OTE	Optimal Trade Entry — 62–79% retrace of the impulse (70.5% favoured).
PD array	Premium/Discount array — any graded reaction level inside the dealing range.
PDH / PDL	Previous day's high / low (also PWH/PWL weekly).
PO3	Power of Three — synonym of AMD in ICT usage.
Silver Bullet	Timed FVG model inside a one-hour killzone (classic 10–11 ET).
SMT	Smart Money Technique / divergence between correlated markets.
Turtle Soup	Fade of a stop-run through an obvious old high or low.
Unicorn	Confluence of FVG and order block in the same pocket.

Term	Short definition
Venom	2025 NY-open model built on opening range + displacement + first FVG.

Disclaimer

This taxonomy is an independent study aid compiled from publicly available titles, playlist structure, and widely documented lecture themes on The Inner Circle Trader YouTube channel. It is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or a transcript of Michael J. Huddleston. Definitions are compressed; the lectures are the authority. ICT revises emphasis across years — when a 2025 lecture tightens a 2016 definition, use the later tape for execution and keep the earlier tape for vocabulary. Nothing here is financial advice. Markets involve risk of loss.

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